

## Question 56 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse how the choice among on-the-job, off-the-job, and e-learning methods can affect training outcomes.

### Introduction

Outcomes mean what happens at Kirkpatrick's levels — did they like it, learn, change behaviour, and improve results? Method is not a decoration. On-the-job, off-the-job and e-learning create different kinds of learning experiences, different costs, and different transfer patterns. Analysis should take each method, then discuss fit, blending, and climate.

### Detailed points

- 1. On-the-job outcomes.** Typically strong relevance and transfer (good path to level 3) if the coach is skilled and has time. Outcomes become bad if the coach is busy or teaches shortcuts: then the organisation mass-produces wrong methods. OJT can also injure on dangerous tasks. Outcome quality follows coach quality more than the label 'OJT'.
- 2. Off-the-job outcomes.** Typically better conceptual learning and safer practice (stronger level 2 for new or risky skills). Level 3 suffers if the classroom does not resemble work or if bosses do not continue coaching. Cost and time away from work can be high; if TNA was weak, outcomes are expensive irrelevance with possibly high reaction (nice venue).
- 3. E-learning outcomes.** Good for consistent knowledge, scale, tracking (level 2 for information; level 1 depends on design quality). Weak completion if self-discipline or connectivity is poor. Weak for complex interpersonal skill unless blended with role play. Outcome risk: organisations think 'we have an LMS so people are trained' while completion and transfer are low.
- 4. Fit to objective changes outcomes more than fashion.** Motor skill → OJT or simulation. Interpersonal skill → role play then OJT. Information update → e-learning. Wrong fit lowers outcomes regardless of budget. Analysis: choose method from TNA, not from what is trendy.
- 5. Learner and context factors.** New employees often need structured off-the-job. Experienced staff may prefer OJT or micro e-learning. Scattered locations favour e-learning. Mismatch reduces motivation and therefore learning outcomes.
- 6. Blended outcomes are often superior.** Concept via e-learning or class, practice off-the-job, application on-the-job with a coach. Each method covers another's weakness. Analysis: the choice is frequently 'how to combine', not 'which one winner'.
- 7. Climate can cancel any method.** If the workplace punishes new behaviour, OJT, classroom and e-learning all fail at level 3. Method analysis without transfer climate is incomplete.
- 8. Analytical close.** Outcomes are produced by fit + quality of execution + transfer support, not by the brand name of the method. Method choice is a strategic HRD decision because it shapes whether learning stays in the head or appears in job performance.

**Conclusion.** OJT favours transfer but depends on coaches; off-the-job favours safe conceptual and skill practice but risks transfer failure; e-learning favours scale and knowledge consistency but risks low completion and weak people-skills. Fit, blending and climate decide outcomes. Write this analysis, not three disconnected definitions.